


Naina Devi Temple, Nainital

Various circuits are being formed by the state government in Devbhoomi Uttarakhand. Apart from Char Dham, tourists and devotees visiting Uttarakhand can become part of virtue by visiting Bhagwati Circuit, Shiv Circuit, Vishnu Circuit, Golu Devta Circuit, Nagdevta Circuit, Hanuman Circuit, Gurudwara Circuit, Navagraha Circuit and Vivekananda Circuit.

— Satpal Maharaj
Tourism Minister, Uttarakhand

The ancient Chandi Devi Temple in Haridwar is set atop Neel Parvat and is dedicated to the Goddess Chandi. Also in Haridwar is the Mansa Devi Temple. The deity, Goddess Mansa, is said to grant the wishes of true devotees. The Kalinka Mata Temple in Bironkhal, Pauri Garhwal, is dedicated to Goddess Kali. Every three years, a grand fair is held here in winter. The Surkanda Devi Temple in Dhanaulti is dedicated to the Goddess Durga and offers panoramic views of the surrounding countryside.

Other important Devi temples in Garhwal include Kunjapuri Temple, Narendra Nagar (Goddess Sati); Chandrabadani Temple, Tehri Garhwal district; Jwalpa Devi Temple, Pauri (Goddess Jwalpa/Kali); Nanda Devi Temple, Nauti, Chamoli (Goddess Nanda Devi); Hariyali Devi Temple, Rudraprayag (Goddess Hariyali Devi); Kalimath Temple, Rudraprayag (Mahalakshmi, Mahasaraswati and Mahakali); Dhari Devi Temple, Pauri (Goddess Dhari Devi); and Narani Devi Temple, Uttarkashi.

THE DEVI TEMPLES OF KUMAON

Kumaon is home to several important Devi temples. The Naina Devi Temple, close to the northern banks of Naini Lake in Nainital, is one of the Shakti Peethas and, therefore, one of the holiest temples in India. It is believed that the eye of Sati fell here. The Nanda Devi Temple in Almora town, located above the Mall Road, is dedicated to Nanda Devi, an incarnation of Goddess Durga. The Dunagiri Temple is located 14 kilometres from Dwarahat, and is dedicated to the Goddess Durga. The belief is that a part of the Sanjeevani Mountain which Lord Hanuman was carrying fell here.

Surrounded by pine and deodar trees, the ancient Kasar Devi Temple overlooks Almora town and the Hawalbagh valley. Swami Vivekananda visited this temple in the 1890s. Each year in November-December, on Kartika Poornima, the annual Kasar Devi Fair is held here. Nine kilometres from Thal, Pithoragarh's Kotgari (Kokila) Devi Temple is considered the final divine court where devotees come to appeal to the Goddess for their wishes to be fulfilled.

Other Devi temples in Kumaon include Mata Purnagiri Temple, Tanakpur; Haat Kalika Temple, Gangolihaat (Goddess Kali); Kot Bhramari Temple, Bageshwar; Maa Barahi Devi Temple, Devidhura; Akhil Tarani Temple, Champawat; Chaiti Devi Temple, Kashipur (Maa Bal Sundari Devi); and Garjiya Devi Temple, Garjiya, Nainital.


Golu Devta Temple, Almora


Kunjapuri Temple, Narendra Nagar

GOLU DEVTA, ALMORA

Golu Devta or Lord Golu is the legendary God of the Kumaon region. He is an incarnation of Lord Shiva in his Gaur Bhairav form. The Dana Golu Devta Temple at Gairar is the most ancient temple of Golu Devta in Kumaon. It is about two kilometres from the main gate of Binsar Wildlife Sanctuary and about 15 kilometres from Almora. Other temples of Golu Devta in Kumaon include Chitai, Champawat and Ghorakhal. The Chitai Golu Devta Temple in Almora is nine kilometres from Almora town. The devout believe that any wish made at this temple will come true. The temple looks distinctive because of the large number of copper bells hanging here.

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